thaw in the Cold War and increase in the national liberation struggles. Also, between 23 March and 15 June 1964, the First UN Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) met in Geneva and the Group of 77 was born, composed of countries primarily from the non-aligned movement.

The Cairo Declaration was anti-colonialist and anti-imperialist. It also welcomed the improvement in the East–West relations. The question of disarmament also received equal attention and the Partial Test Ban Treaty was commended, and there was a plea for a total ban on nuclear weapons. There was also recommendation for setting up of denuclearized zones, wherever feasible. The Conference also opposed racial discrimination and the Declaration strongly condemned the policy of apartheid in South Africa and called for sanctions against the Republic of South Africa. It also recognized nationalist movements as being the 'authentic representatives' of colonial peoples and affirmed that those under the colonial rule, foreign occupation or racist regime, might legitimately resort to arms to secure their full independence. The Conference called upon the member States to provide necessary material support—financial and military—to the peoples engaged in freedom struggle. The NAM countries asserted that political independence and self-determination were primary conditions for peace and drew attention to the tensions being caused by external interference in the Congo, Cyprus, Cuba and Indo-China where people were trying to grapple with the problems of development. Therefore, the Conference claimed that world peace could only be established with the abolition of imperialism, colonialism and neo-colonialism. On economic matters, the NAM countries stated that "Persistence of poverty poses a threat to world peace and prosperity". They opined that peoples and nations should have the right to control their national wealth and resources for their own economic development and concluded that "a new and just economic order" must be established to foster development in the Third World countries. The Declaration also called for cultural, scientific and educational cooperation at international and regional levels. A number of recommendations made in Cairo, especially those with regard to national liberation struggles, were later adopted at the UN, largely through the untiring